GuildofStudents
University of Birmingham

Job Description:
Kitchen Shift Leader

Post Title: Kitchen Shift Leader

Responsible to: Kitchen Manager

Responsible for: Kitchen Staff Team (as appropriate)

Grade: Guild Grade A

Organisation:

This role is part of the Venues department working collectively with colleagues delivering the Guild's large-scale events, bars, catering, security and technical services (sound, light & production). The Venues team is part of the Engagement Directorate.

Job Purpose:

The Kitchen Shift Leader role is to support delivery of the Venues departmental plan. We expect the role to help to create an inclusive and engaging environment for all.

The role is required:

- To be responsible for the day-to-day operation of the kitchen, with the main focus being to support the operation of bars.
- To supervise student staff.
- To assist in the administrative responsibilities of staff training, stock control and Health & Safety documentation.

Success in the role will require a highly student and customer focused approach together with an emphasis on teamwork. The role involves collaboration with internal and external stakeholders, acting as a positive ambassador for the Guild and facilitating under-represented groups to find a comfortable place here. Supporting a culture of ambitious targets and a positive team spirit are also key. Kitchen Shift Leaders are expected to follow the Guild's competency framework, which should be read in conjunction with this job description.

Duties and Responsibilities

Key Role Responsibilities:

1. To work with the Kitchen Manager and the Pub Manager to lead the kitchen team to ensure the smooth running of the kitchen, environment, food storage, preparation and production in line with Guild and brand specifications and standards.

2. To provide an agreed and consistent standard of food production and presentation during all working hours, ensuring that all food production and operation adhere to specified food cost percentage without compromising any legal, Guild or JDW requirements.

3. Ensure compliance to legislative standards and Guild policy including: - Health & Safety at Work 1974, Management of Health & Safety at Work 1992, Employment Law 1996, Licensing Act 1964, Fire Regulations, Trade Descriptions, Food Handling, Weights & Measures.

4. Proactively manage and continually maintain the teams product knowledge to ensure it is up to date.

5. Proactively monitor and review the food presented to customers and ensure it meets agreed standards.

6. To ensure that the kitchen team respond to customers' requests, needs or dissatisfaction in an appropriate and proactive manner, in line with policy.

7. Proactively monitor and review product delivery, storage preparation and service to ensure it is in line with legislative standards and JDW and Guild policy and advise as appropriate.

8. Ensure the Guild and JDW policy on Food Handling and Risk Assessments are strictly adhered to and advise as appropriate of any actions needed. COSHH and HACCP assessments are in place and frequently reviewed to ensure compliance with legislation and Guild policy.

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9. Promote and practice all aspects of due diligence in Health & Safety in the workplace to protect both customers and staff.

10. Monitor and review all products to ensure they are presented and portioned as per brand menu specification.

11. Monitor, review and conduct kitchen cleaning schedules as specified for due diligence to meet legal compliance.

12. Maintain and update training records accurately and comprehensively as appropriate.

13. Monitor team to ensure all are presented in a clean and professional manner in line with Guild and JDW brand standards.

14. Monitor and review stock rotation and par levels.

15. Ensure appropriate and timely ordering of stock in accordance with level of trade forecast.

16. Support the Kitchen Manager to ensure menus achieve set gross profit margins.

17. Minimise wastage through correct training, planning, preparation and cooking.

18. To work with the Kitchen Manager to build a cohesive working relationship to ensure smooth transition of communication within the venue.

19. Monitor and review the maintenance of the kitchen equipment and report problems/ make recommendations in line with JDW, Guild and brand procedures quickly and effectively.

20. Only order through nominated suppliers or those authorised by JDW.

21. To be responsible for informing the Kitchen Manager of all developments and issues relating to the food operation.

22. To ensure effective communication with the staff team, relevant local authorities and other contacts to ensure all policy decisions, managerial and legislative requirements are actioned by the staff team.

23. To be responsible for the security, safety and levels of stock and report and discrepancies.

24. Through supervision, ensure kitchen staff are effectively delivering promotional concepts and activities so as to maximise income generation.

25. To develop and maintain effective relationships with relevant local and university stakeholders.

26. To identify improvements and recommend these to the Kitchen Manager for consideration.

General Duties:

1. To undertake appropriate training and personal development as required for the role.

2. To adhere to all relevant Guild Policy with particular reference to HR, staffing, health & safety, data protection, environmental, and any relevant Guild Policy where it may impact upon your role.

3. To be familiar with the Guild's competency framework, striving always to demonstrate the positive behaviours which drive the highest standards of personal and organisational performance in supporting our students. Grade A roles should be developing within level 1 of the six competencies (Student and Customer Focus, Accountability, Results Focus,

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Inclusivity, Communication and Teamwork) which is designed to support staff to achieve high performance.

4. To act as a role model in portraying a positive image of the Guild both internally and externally, acting as an ambassador and displaying high standards of personal integrity and professionalism.

5. To support the work of the Venues Team, where necessary, in the event of sickness, holiday or other exceptional circumstances.

6. To undertake such other duties as may be reasonably required, consistent with the nature and grade of the post.

March 2026

Person Specification: Kitchen Shift Leader

You must be able to demonstrate in your application that you have;

	Essential	Desirable
QUALIFICATIONS		
Good general education, typically including Maths and English at least to GSCE C, or equivalent	✓	
Level 2 Food Hygiene Certificate	✓	
City & Guild/NVQ level 2 Catering or relevant experience	✓	
EXPERIENCE		
Relevant skills & experience in commercial kitchens	✓	
Knowledge of relevant food legislation	✓	
Experience of managing a small kitchen staff team	✓	
Experience / Knowledge of customer care	✓	
Experience of developing and managing relationships with stakeholders to deliver service	✓	
SKILLS AND KNOWLEDGE		
Ability to present information clearly and concisely in writing or verbally, with adequate written and spoken English	✓	
Ability to establish working relationships with a wide range of individuals both within and outside the Guild, to include the University, students, staff and clients	✓	
Ability to work using own initiative	✓	
Good IT skills including proficiency in Microsoft Office including word processing and spread sheets		✓
Information gathering skills, for example acquiring knowledge of relevant legislation	✓	
Ability to work effectively within a democratic structure		✓
Ability to take a constructive and co-operative approach to solving problems	✓	
PERSONAL QUALITIES		
Motivated by working in a student-led, democratic workplace	✓	
Student & Customer focus: Keeps student leadership and the needs of students and customers at the heart of activities	✓	

Accountability: Takes personal responsibility for the important role they play in the Guild's work and in wider society	✓	
Results Focus: Strives for the best results – gets things done on time and to a high standard	✓	
Inclusivity: Values diversity - works to create an inclusive and engaging environment across all our activities and services	✓	
Communication: Communicates clearly and appropriately to people across our students' union and outside	✓	
Teamwork: Builds good relationships and works effectively with a range of people to deliver our shared goals	✓	

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